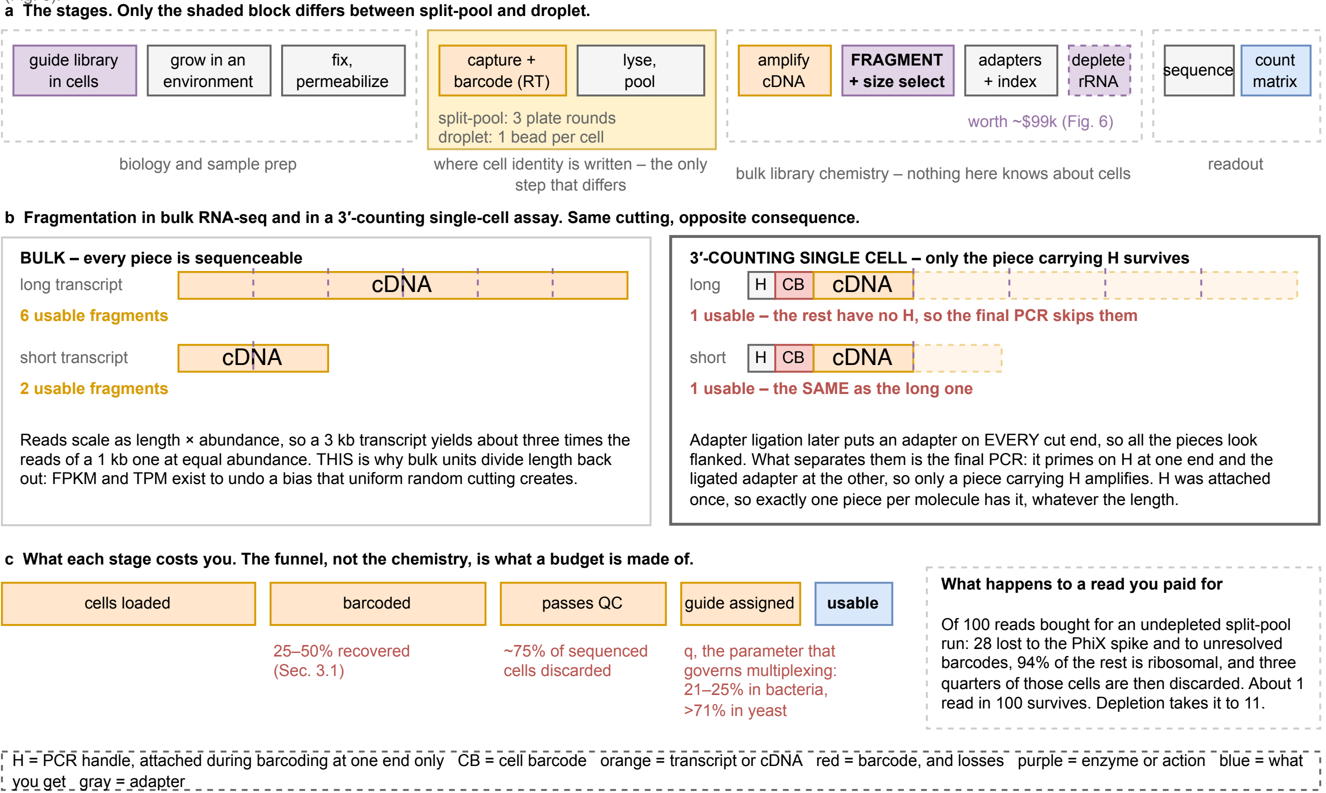
The whole experiment, and where each stage can lose you cells, molecules or identity

Read left to right. The wet-lab stages are the same for both method families; what differs is only how cells are kept apart while their barcodes are written (Figs. 2 to 4). Fragmentation is drawn explicitly because it is the step that decides whether a count means “molecules” or “molecules times length”, and because ribosomal RNA depletion is placed relative to it (Fig. 6).



Panel b is the reason this figure exists. Bulk and single-cell protocols perform the SAME physical cutting, and the consequence inverts because of what happens afterwards: in bulk every piece can be sequenced, so reads scale with length; in a 3′-counting assay only the piece carrying the outer handle can be, so exactly one survives per molecule regardless of length. Applying TPM or FPKM to a 10x or SPLiT-seq count matrix is therefore an error, not a stylistic choice. Composed from the protocols as described in Secs. 2.4, 3.1 and 3.2, not traced from any published figure. Every number drawn by hand here is sourced in the provenance table for this figure.